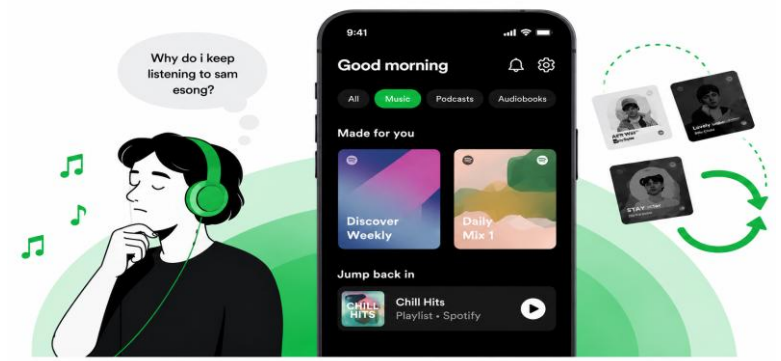




Reimagining Music Discovery Beyond the Loop



Increasing meaningful discovery and reducing repetitive listening to grow engagement, loyalty, and long-term value. So, the next growth unlock is breaking the loop of the familiar.

! THE PROBLEM Source !!

A significant share of listening comes from **repeat playlists, familiar artists, and previously discovered tracks**.
Over-reliance on familiarity reduces excitement, limits exploration, and weakens the perceived value of Spotify as a discovery platform.

OUR GOAL

Increase meaningful music discovery by helping users explore relevant new content confidently without losing the personalization they love.

WHY DISCOVERY MATTER Source !!

- **Stronger Engagement**
More discovery = more listening depth & frequency
- **Higher Retention**
Users who discover stay longer and churn less
- **Artist & Catalog Growth**
Increase exposure for more artists and tracks
- **Business Impact**
Drives premium adoption, LTV, and topline growth



Current State

Listening is driven by **familiarity, habit**, and **low-risk choices**.



Behavioral Shift

Make discovery feel **relevant, effortless, and trustworthy**.



Business Impact Source !!

Greater **discovery, stronger loyalty**, and **higher lifetime value**.

*Better discovery creates **better experiences**, Better experiences build a **stronger Spotify***



 Spotify

AI Review Intelligence Reveals **Discovery Is Spotify's Largest Growth Opportunity** [GITHUB REPOSITORY](#)

Built an AI-powered review analysis engine to understand why users struggle to discover new music. 27.4K reviews across 4 sources were analyzed using an AI pipeline with Gemini (LLM) + RAG to extract themes, sentiment, segments, and behavior insights.

SOURCES ANALYZED

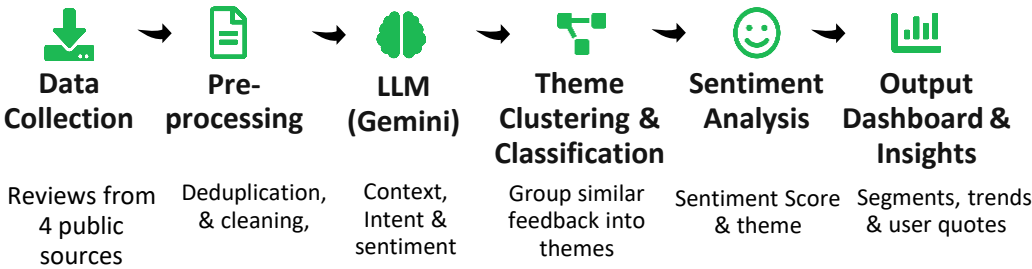
 Google Play	4.7K reviews	3.5 ★ avg rating
 App Store	11.8K reviews	3.9 ★ avg rating
 Reddit	9K reviews	57/100 sentiment
 Community Forums	1.9K reviews	37/100 sentiment

ATTACHMENTS

 AI SYSTEM BREAKDOWN

 VIEW DEPLOYED AI SYSTEM

AI REVIEW INTELLIGENCE WORKFLOW



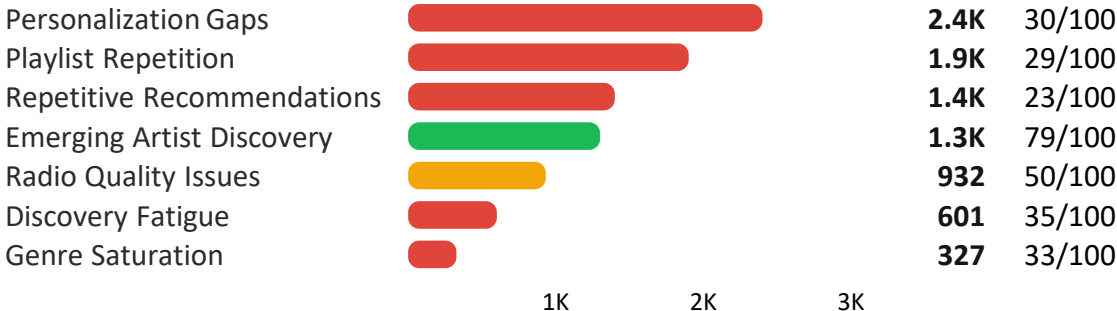
REVIEWS AT A GLANCE

Total Reviews	Discovery Reviews	Avg Rating	Sentiment Score	Discovery Satisfaction
Across 4 sources	48% are about discovery	Store ratings (1-5★)	Overall mood (0-100)	Among discovery reviews
27.4K	13.3K	3.79	60	54/100

WHAT USERS STRUGGLE WITH

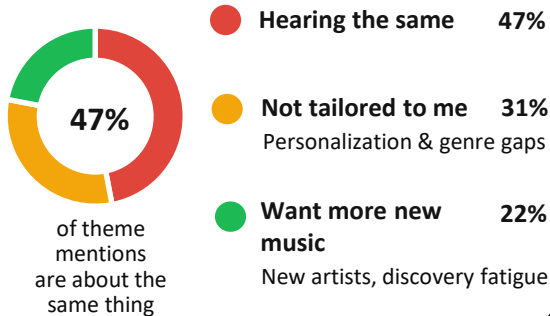
■ Negative ■ Mixed ■ Positive

Discovery themes by mentions + sentiment (13.3K discovery reviews)



THE REPETITION PROBLEM

Where discovery pain concentrates



WHO'S MOST FRUSTRATED

Discovery-complaint rate by user segment

#	Segment	Complaint Rate	Reviews
1	Premium · Power User	28%	2.1K
2	Free User	19%	3.2K
3	Premium · Casual	11%	241
4	New User	3%	106

KEY INSIGHTS FROM AI REVIEW INTELLIGENCE

Discovery Is the Largest Opportunity:
48% of reviews discuss discovery, making it Spotify's biggest product opportunity.

Repetition Drives Frustration:
47% of discovery complaints stem from repetitive songs, artists, and playlists.

Premium Users Need Attention:
Premium Power Users have the highest complaint rate (28%), making them the highest-impact segment.

 Spotify

Target segment & Opportunity identification

Identifying the highest-impact users to unlock meaningful music discovery and drive long-term value

**OUR OBJECTIVE**

Identify the highest-impact user segment and quantify the opportunity to improve meaningful discovery, trust, and long-term business outcomes.

POTENTIAL USER SEGMENTS

User groups based on Behavior, Value & Pain.

**Premium Power Users** Highest potential

High usage, long tenure Premium subscribers

**Free Users** Medium potential

Ad-supported users with lower engagement

**Premium Casuals** Medium potential

Premium users with low engagement

**New Users** Lower potential

Users with < 3 months tenure.

**We will focus on the segment with the highest pain intensity and business impact.**

OPPORTUNITY SIZING

Detailed Explanation !

Assumption based potential opportunity sizing.

**Spotify MAUs** ~ 761M
**Premium Subscribers** ~ 293M
**Long-Tenure Users (>1 yr)** ~ 175M
**Heavy Listeners (>2hrs/day)** ~ 52M
**Users Reporting Discovery Fatigue** ~ 15M
**High-Potential Opportunity** ~ 7 - 10M

**Total Monthly Active Users, Q1 2026**
**Paying subscribers, higher engagement & LTV**
**Assume ~60% of Premium users, tenure >1 year**
**Assume ~30% of long-tenure users listen >2 hrs/day**
**~ 28% complaint rate based on AI review System, 27.4K reviews**
**~50-65% of heavy listeners hit fatigued users are the high-intent, high-value**

A 10% uplift in discovery satisfaction across the ~ 7 - 10M high-intent segment
~ 700K – 1M users moved from
frustrated → confident discoverers / High LTV + High Influence → disproportionate downstream impact

WHERE IS THE REAL OPPORTUNITY?

Discovery Attempt × Discovery Success

DISCOVERY ATTEMPT	High	 Explorers Enthusiasts High intent, good success. Engaged & discovering meaningfully.	 HIGHEST OPPORTUNITY High Intent, Low trust Discoverers High intent, low success. Try hard, hit dead ends, lose trust.
	Low	 Comfort Listeners Low intent, high success. Happy with what they already listen to.	 Disengaged Listeners Low intent, low success. Not engaged in discovery at all.
		Low	High

DISCOVERY SUCCESS

**The opportunity isn't more recommendations it's rebuilding trust in discovery.**

WHY PRIORITIZE HIGH-INTENT, LOW-TRUST DISCOVERERS?

-  High discovery attempts (3.2x higher than average users)
-  Low success leads to repetition (2.7x more skips on recommended tracks)
-  Lowest confidence in Spotify discovery (31%)
-  Highest risk of churn if discovery doesn't improve
-  High value: long tenure, high usage, high LTV potential

Directional, from AI Review Intelligence

HYPOTHESES TO VALIDATE

What we believe is causing discovery pain and what will solve it.

**H1** Repetition erodes trust in Spotify recommendations

**H2** Dead-end discovery experiences make users disengage.

**H3** Novelty with preserved relevance improves discovery success.

**H4** Context-aware discovery (mood, time, activity) boosts relevance.

**H6** Trust in discovery strongly predicts engagement & retention.

**KEY TAKEAWAY**

High-Intent, Low-Trust Discoverers, the high-intent core of our Premium Power Users try hard to discover but rarely succeed. Solving their discovery pain will drive the biggest impact on engagement, retention, and long-term value.

**WHAT'S WRONG WITH DISCOVERY TODAY?**

- Too repetitive: same artists, songs, vibes
- Not enough novel artists or unexpected picks
- Lack of personalization to mood, context & moment
- Limited control over discovery depth & direction
- Discovery surfaces feel passive, not engaging
- Low confidence: users switch to other apps

Root cause: The Gap is Trust, not Intent driven by familiarity-biased, context-blind recommendations



USER RESEARCH & PROBLEM VALIDATION

Primary research confirms a high-value user segment is struggling with discovery fatigue.

SOURCES



Survey N = 35
(Google Form)



1:1 Interviews N = 7
(Structured)



<-- SURVEY LINKS -->



USER SEGMENT



High-Intent, Low-Trust Discoverers

Premium users who have used Spotify for **more than 1 year**, listen **2+ hours** daily, **value discovering new music**.
But increasingly rely on familiar playlists and external platforms because Spotify's recommendations feel **repetitive and unpredictable**.



PLAN
Premium



TENURE
> 1 year



LISTENING TIME
> 2 hours/day



MOTIVATION
Discover new music



CURRENT BEHAVIOR
Replay familiar content



ALTERNATIVES
Instagram, YouTube, Friends



DESIRED OUTCOME
Relevant novelty with control & discovery ease

WHY THIS SEGMENT?



HIGH PAIN

Repetition & low confidence in recommendations



HIGH VALUE

Premium + Heavy listeners = High LTV



HIGH FREQUENCY

Daily usage & high time spent



HIGH UNMET NEED

Want discovery but don't trust the system



ACTIONABLE WITH AI

Contextual, personalized discovery can win back trust & engagement



High pain x High value x High engagement = **Highest ROI segment**

SURVEY EVIDENCE (N = 35)



Long-tenure users use Spotify for > 3 years, all within our >1yr segment



40% listen >2 hrs/day (our target cohort); another 49% listen 1-2 hrs/day



Mostly listen to familiar music



Discovery importance (avg. rating) 4.03/5



Say playlists contain the same songs repeatedly



Use social media to discover new music



Users want **discovery**, but **don't find it reliably on Spotify**.

1:1 INTERVIEW EVIDENCE (N = 7)

"I always go back to my liked songs. New recommendations **rarely match my vibe**." : User 1

"Recommendations are repetitive. I want music that **fits my mood and keeps the vibe going**." : User 2

"There are **no good filters or controls**. I don't know where to search for new artists." : User 4

"I want new music for **specific situations** like gym or work. I need **more control**." : User 5



Users **crave relevant novelty with control and context**.

LISTENING OBSERVATION INSIGHTS



Default Behavior



Users start with Liked Songs, recent plays, or personal playlists.



Discovery Attempts



Users try recommendations but abandon them quickly.



External Validation



Users validate and discover music outside Spotify (social media, friends, YouTube).



Outcome



New music is manually searched, saved, and added back to Spotify.



KEY OBSERVATION

Our **most valuable listeners** want new music but have **lost confidence** in Spotify's **ability to deliver it**. They **fall back on familiar listening** and **rely on external platforms** to discover what **Spotify should be delivering**.



FROM LISTENING BEHAVIOR TO THE CORE TRUST PROBLEM

Users love music, but struggle to discover new music that truly fits them. This leads to repetitive listening and dependence on external platforms.



THE CORE PROBLEM

High-intent listeners no longer trust Spotify to consistently surface relevant novelty, causing them to retreat to familiar content and discover elsewhere.



The Discovery Seeker

High-Intent, Low-Trust Discoverer
Curious | Open-minded | Social

” I want new music that matches my vibe, but Spotify keeps repeating the same stuff.



JTBD

When I want to discover new music, help me find songs that truly fit my taste and context so I can explore confidently without endless searching.

Goals

- Discover fresh music and hidden gems
- Explore new artists and songs before they become mainstream.

Pain Points

- Recommendations feel repetitive
- Discovery requires too much effort



The Comfort Listener

Routine-driven | Comfort-seeking

” I just want music that fits my mood without me having to search too hard.



JTBD

When I need music for my current mood, help me instantly find the right songs, so I can stay in the flow without extra effort.

Goals

- Stay in the flow and keep the mood consistent
- Replays familiar content.

Pain Points

- Recommendations don't match mood/context
- Limited control over suggestions

WHY REPETITION HAPPENS



Recommendations optimize for familiarity over novelty



Discovery lacks context (mood, activity, intent)



Users have low confidence in recommendation quality



Exploration feels risky while familiarity feels safe

SYSTEM GAPS IDENTIFIED



Over-optimized for what's already known
Algorithms prioritize familiarity over meaningful novelty.



Limited understanding of real-time context
Mood, activity, and intent are not deeply understood.



One-size-fits-all recommendations
Lack of user control over novelty and discovery depth.



Discovery happens outside Spotify
We're not winning the moment of discovery.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Users have **high intent but low trust** in Spotify's discovery experience.

One experience serves both: the MVP's Comfort ↔ Adventurous **control lets Discovery Seekers** dial up novelty while **Comfort Listeners stay in their comfort zone.**

PROBLEM FRAMING CANVAS

Pinpointing the core problem that's hurting users and the business.

” I want Spotify to help me discover new music that fits my mood and taste without me having to search outside the app.

— User 2



WHAT IS THE TRUE PROBLEM?

High-intent listeners want to discover new music / artist, but **repeated poor recommendations** have eroded their trust in Spotify's ability to surface relevant novelty.

As a result, they retreat to **familiar listening** and rely on **external platforms** for **discovery, limiting engagement** and **long-term retention**.



WHO FACES THIS PROBLEM THE MOST?

High-Intent, Low-Trust Discoverers:

Long-tenure Premium listeners (>2 hrs/day) who actively value discovering new music but no longer trust Spotify's recommendations to consistently surface relevant novelty.



HOW DO WE KNOW IT'S A REAL PROBLEM?

- ✓ Survey (N=35): **57%** users use Spotify >3 years
- ✓ **49%** listen 1-2 hrs/day
- ✓ **64%** say playlists contain the same songs repeatedly
- ✓ **88%** use social media / external apps to discover new music
- ✓ 1:1 Interviews (N=7) validate low trust in recommendations



VALUE FOR THE TARGET USERS

- ✓ Discover new music that truly fits their mood & taste
- ✓ Save time and effort in searching
- ✓ Feel excited and surprised by relevant music
- ✓ Build trust in Spotify as their go-to music companion



VALUE FOR THE BUSINESS

- ✓ Higher engagement & listening time
- ✓ Stronger retention and long-term loyalty
- ✓ Increased Premium differentiation
- ✓ Reduced churn & external dependency
- ✓ More discovery → more consumption → more revenue



WHY SOLVE IT NOW?

- ✓ Competition (YouTube, Instagram, TikTok) is winning discovery moments
- ✓ AI/ML advancements enable much more personalized discovery
- ✓ User trust is declining, risk of losing loyal users
- ✓ Improving discovery is a key growth lever for engagement and revenue



CORE PROBLEM STATEMENT

Spotify is **losing high-intent** users' trust in discovery because it does not reliably surface relevant new music in the moments they **actively seek**: it on **demand, in context, and with control**.



IDEATION & DECISION MAKING

Exploring the strongest solutions to make music discovery more intentional, relevant and meaningful.

SOLUTION 1

Discovery Session (AI-Powered)

☆

💡 Idea

AI-guided discovery sessions where users set the vibe, intent and preferences. AI curates a personalized mix of high-quality new music.

☆ Key Features

- Intent & mood selection
- Discovery level (Comfort ↔ Adventurous)
- AI-curated real-time discovery queue
- Save, follow & refine during session
- Learns & improves with feedback

👤 User Needs Solved

- Don't know where to start discovery
- Need relevant new music, not random songs
- Want control without too much effort
- Want to explore with confidence

SOLUTION 2

What Should Play Next? (User-Controlled Filters)

🔍

💡 Idea

When a user searches for a song and plays the song, they can choose filters to control what plays next based on mood, genre, language, energy, era, or discovery preferences.

☆ Key Features

- Smart filters for next songs (mood, genre, era, language, energy, similar / new / hidden gems)
- Adjust discovery level & familiarity
- Quick apply & play next
- Easy refinement of queue

👤 User Needs Solved

- Wants control over what they explore
- Wants music matching their current mood or activity
- Wants relevant variety without losing vibe
- Wants faster & easier discovery

💡 Both solutions empower users and improve discovery.

Detailed Explanation

SOLUTION	IMPACT (On Users & Business)	CONFIDENCE (In Success)	EFFORT (To Build)	ICE SCORE (Impact × Confidence / Effort)	RANK
1. Discovery Session (AI-Powered)	9.5 Very High	8.5 High	6.0 Medium	13.4	1
2. What Should Play Next? (User-Controlled Filters)	8.0 High	7.5 High	4.5 Low-Medium	13.3	2

🎯

OUR GOAL

Help users discover meaningful new music with **control, context, and confidence.**

👥

USER INSIGHTS

🔍

"I want new music, but I don't know where to start."
Users struggle with starting discovery.

🔧

"I want control over what I explore."
Users want say in mood, vibe and how adventurous recommendations are.

🌟

"I leave Spotify to discover."
Users go to Instagram, reels, or friends because discovery feels easier elsewhere.

💚

"I want songs that feel like me."
Users want relevant discovery that fits their moment and emotional state.

📊

Business Impact

- More discovery sessions per user
- Higher saves, follows, and playlist adds
- Increased Premium engagement & retention
- Stronger long-term LTV

🏆

DECISION

We are moving forward with **SOLUTION 1**

Discovery Session (AI-Powered)

We are **prioritizing Discovery Session** to create the biggest shift in meaningful music discovery as it delivers the highest impact with strong user need alignment and long-term business value.

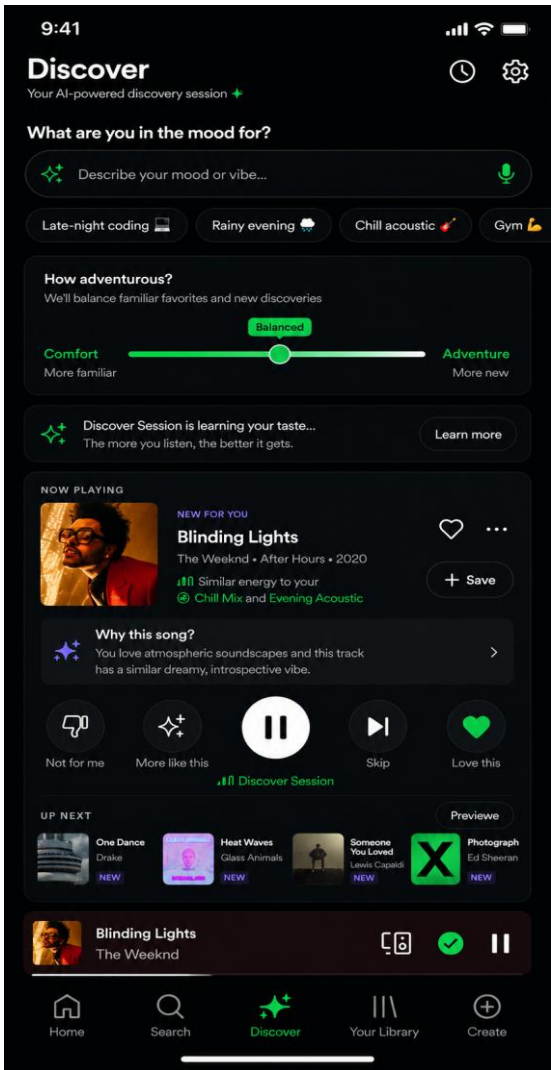
✅ **AI is our discovery advantage.**



MVP: USER FLOW & FEATURE SCOPE

Solution 1 – Discovery Session (AI-Powered): AI-curated discovery sessions that adapt to user intent, mood and taste to help them discover meaningful new music.

1. SCREEN (HIGH-LEVEL UI FLOW)



2. FEATURE OVERVIEW

Discovery Session is an AI-powered experience that helps users discover new music based on their mood, activity, context and taste.

- Intent & Mood Input**
Users tell us how they feel or what they are doing.
- AI Curated Queue**
AI builds a personalized queue blending familiar favorites with new discoveries.
- Adaptive Learning**
AI learns from likes, skips and saves in real-time to improve recommendations.
- Meaningful Discovery**
Focus on songs and artists users are likely to love and remember.
- Seamless Experience**
Everything in a single flow from intent to discovery.

Detailed User workflow



Working Prototype

3. SCOPE (MVP)

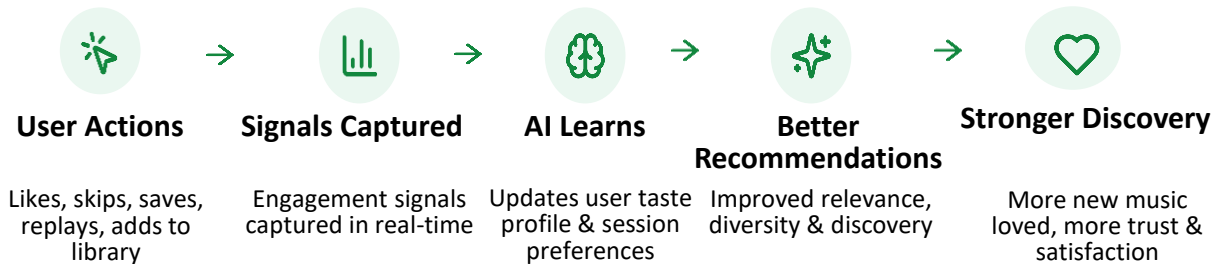
IN SCOPE

- Start discovery session from Discover tab
- Mood / Activity / Context input (text + voice)
- AI-curated queue (10-20 songs)
- Like / Dislike / Skip / Save
- Real-time queue adaptation
- Why this song (AI explanation)
- Up Next preview
- Session summary (new artists, favorites)

OUT OF SCOPE (MVP)

- Social sharing of sessions
- Collaborative sessions
- Advanced personalization settings
- Long-term memory across sessions
- Offline mode for sessions
- Voice-only mood input (phase 2)
- Video / podcast integration

4. PERSONALIZATION LOOP (Continuous Learning)



Each session makes the next one better.

WHY THIS MVP?

- ✓ Gives users control & confidence
- ✓ Increases saves, follows & retention
- ✓ Makes discovery intentional & relevant
- ✓ Foundation for deeper personalization
- ✓ Real-time learning improves experience

MVP IMPACT

Empowers users to discover the right music, in the right mood, at the right time.

We are building **trust** through **control**.



MEASURING SUCCESS – METRICS

Measuring the right metrics to ensure Discovery Session (AI-Powered) drives meaningful discovery, user satisfaction and long-term Spotify growth.



OUR GOAL

Empower users to discover the right music, in the right mood, at the right time.

NORTH STAR METRIC

Discovery Success Rate (DSR) ✨

% of Discovery Sessions that result in meaningful discovery actions.

DSR = (# Discovery Sessions with ≥1 meaningful discovery action) / (Total Discovery Sessions)

Meaningful Discovery Actions

% of sessions with ≥1 song saved

% of sessions with ≥1 song added to playlist

% of sessions with ≥1 new artist followed

% of sessions with a discovered song replayed within 7 days



TARGET

Achieve **15% DSR**

within 6 months of MVP launch

Why this is our North Star?

- ✓ Measures meaningful discovery, not just consumption.
- ✓ Aligns user value with engagement and retention.
- ✓ Balances novelty with recommendation relevance.
- ✓ Directly tracks whether we are rebuilding trust in discovery.

LEADING INDICATORS

Discovery Session Starts per User

of times users start a Discovery Session

Intent Input Completion Rate

% of Discovery Sessions where users provide mood/activity/context inputs

Recommendation Acceptance Rate

% of recommended songs that are liked, saved, followed, or added to playlists

New Artist Exposure Rate

% of Discovery Sessions exposing users to at least one previously unheard artist

Session Depth

Avg. % of recommended songs consumed per Discovery Session

LAGGING INDICATORS

Discovery Retention Rate

% of users who come back to start another Discovery Session within 7 days

Incremental Retention Lift

% lift in D7/D30 retention for Discovery Session user's vs non-users

Library Addition Rate

Avg. % of songs saved from Discovery Sessions per user

New Artist Adoption Rate

% of users who replay a newly discovered artist within 30 days

GUARDRAILS

Total Listening Time

% of change in total listening minutes per user after using Discovery Sessions

Discovery Session Abandonment Rate

% of Discovery Sessions exited before consuming X songs. Ex: 3 Songs

Negative Feedback Rate

% of 'Not for me' / dislike signals

Discovery Satisfaction Satisfaction (CSAT)

% of users rating the Discovery Session >4/5

Recommendation Trust Score

% of users agreeing that recommendations felt relevant and worth exploring.



We will continuously monitor these metrics, learn from user behavior, and iterate to make discovery on Spotify more relevant, enjoyable and trustworthy.

RISKS AND MITIGATION



OUR APPROACH

Anticipate risks. Build safeguards.
Continuously learn and adapt.

Proactively identifying key risks and mitigation strategies to ensure a trustworthy, enjoyable and impactful Discovery Session experience.

RISK	POTENTIAL IMPACT	MITIGATION STRATEGY	MONITORING SIGNALS
 1. Irrelevant or repetitive recommendations Users may not find the discovery relevant, leading to frustration and drop-off.	 High Decreases engagement, trust and session completion.	✓ Leverage rich contextual signals (mood, activity, time, device) and diverse data sources ✓ Continuously train, evaluate and improve models ✓ Feedback loop (likes, skips) to refine recommendations	 • Discovery Success Rate (DSR) • Skip Rate • Session Drop-off Rate • User Feedback (Not for me)
 2. Model bias and lack of diversity AI may over-recommend popular or similar artists, limiting exposure to diverse music.	 Medium – High Limits discovery diversity and long-term user satisfaction.	✓ Use diversity-aware ranking & re-ranking ✓ Monitor catalog & artist diversity in recommendations ✓ Introduce exploration buckets (e.g., 20% new) ✓ Regular bias & fairness audits	 • Recommendation Diversity Score • % New / Unique Artists Discovered • Catalog Coverage • Long-tail Artist Engagement
 3. User privacy concerns Users may worry about how their data is collected and used for personalization.	 High Can impact trust, brand reputation and adoption.	✓ Transparent data usage and clear consent ✓ Privacy-by-design and data minimization ✓ Allow users to control and reset data ✓ Comply with global privacy regulations	 • Privacy Complaints • Opt-out / Data Deletion Rate • Consent Acceptance Rate
 4. Low adoption or low time spent Users may not engage with the feature, limiting business impact.	 Medium – High Limits ROI and strategic value of the feature.	✓ Strong discoverability and in-product onboarding ✓ Iterate based on user behavior and feedback ✓ A/B test experience and communication ✓ Align with user needs and moments	 • Feature Adoption Rate • Time Spent in Discovery Session • Repeat Usage Rate • Impact on Premium Conversion



CONTINUOUS RISK MANAGEMENT

We will continuously monitor these risks and signals, learn from data and user feedback, and iterate to build a discovery experience that is delightful, trustworthy and scalable.